

POTBOUND

The Container Garden Planning Workbook

Crop selection, layout planning, a full-season calendar, a watering and feeding tracker, a budget worksheet, and a harvest log — everything needed to plan a container garden from empty balcony to first harvest.

Free — potbound.vercel.app

SECTION 1

Crop Selection Worksheet

Before buying anything, work out what actually fits your space and light. Fill in one row per crop you're considering — the sizes reference our full container-size guides for exact figures by variety.

Crop	Sunlight Available	Container Size Needed	Fits? (Y/N)

Reminder: sunlight need varies by crop — tomatoes, peppers, and cucumbers generally want 6+ hours; lettuce and herbs tolerate 4–6.

SECTION 2

Balcony & Container Layout Planner

Sketch your actual space below. Mark sun-exposed areas, then pencil in where each container will sit — grouping by water needs (see Section 4) makes watering day faster all season.

Legend: ■ full sun ■ partial shade ● full shade ■ container placement

SECTION 3

Seasonal Planting Calendar

Track your actual planting, feeding, and harvest windows below. Exact timing depends on your local frost dates — use this to record what you did, not just what a generic calendar says to do.

[illegible]

SECTION 4

Watering & Feeding Tracker

Container plants dry out faster than in-ground beds — this is the single most common reason container gardens underperform. Log actual watering days for two weeks and you'll usually spot your real pattern.

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SECTION 5

Garden Budget Worksheet

Container gardening costs are front-loaded — containers, soil, and initial plants or seed are most of it. Track actual spend below to see your real cost per season, not just the estimate you started with.

Item	Est. Cost	Actual Cost	One-time / Recurring
Containers			
Potting soil			
Seeds / starter plants			
Fertilizer / feed			
Trellis / support stakes			
Watering equipment			

SECTION 6

Harvest Log

The single best planning tool for next season is an honest record of this one. Note what actually produced well, not just what you expected to.

Date	Crop	Amount Harvested	Notes for Next Season

This workbook is provided free, with no email or account required. For sizing details by variety, see the full crop guides at potbound.vercel.app. Figures throughout are practical starting points — see potbound.vercel.app/about for our method and its limits.